

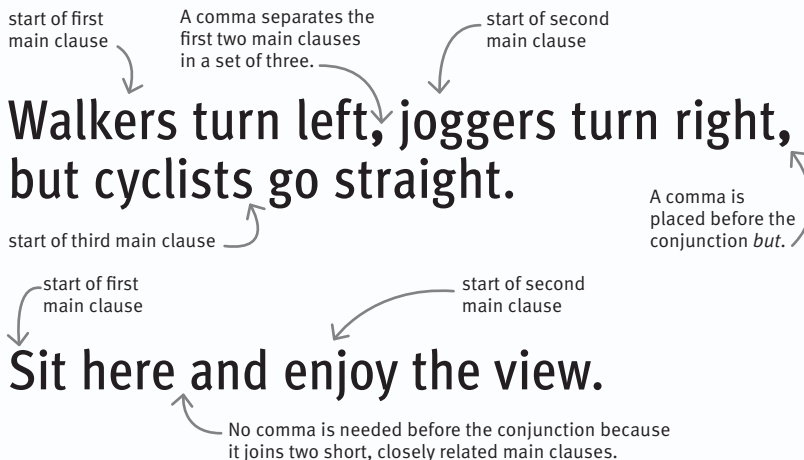
Other uses of commas

COMMAS CAN BE USED TO JOIN MULTIPLE MAIN CLAUSES, REPRESENT OMITTED WORDS, AND SEPARATE ITEMS IN LISTS.

Sentences can be joined using a comma with a conjunction to create the right pace and variety in writing. A comma is also used to avoid repetition and to separate words or phrases in lists.

Commas to join clauses

Commas are used with conjunctions to join two or more main clauses to make a sentence. The comma before the last main clause is followed by one of these conjunctions: *and*, *or*, *but*, *nor*, *for*, *yet*, or *so*. If two clauses are short and closely linked, the comma can be omitted.



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REAL WORLD

Comma butterfly

A comma is also a type of butterfly with a small, white marking on the underside of each of its wings that resembles the punctuation mark.



- Use a **semicolon** to join two related sentences together without a conjunction.
- A **comma** can be used only with the **conjunctions** *and*, *or*, *but*, *for*, *nor*, *yet*, or *so* to **join clauses**.
- **Avoid** using **too many commas**. When a sentence contains a lot of pauses, it is difficult to read.

Commas and omitted words

When avoiding repetition that would make a sentence long and possibly boring, a comma can be used to represent the omitted words.

In the first month of the year, the flower was orange; in the second, red; and in the third, yellow.

A comma is placed after the introductory phrase.

Each of these commas represents the omitted word *month*.